

CARGO INDUSTRY

Lay the track. Place the industry. Move the goods.

A single-player transportation and industrial management strategy game for PC.



Key art: the Cargo Industry logo over an in-game view of the rail and road network between Bridgeford and Riverholt, captured from the current playable build.

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store.steampowered.com/app/5155330/Cargo_Industry

GENRE

Simulation • Strategy • Management

PLATFORM

Windows 10/11 (64-bit), Steam

ENGINE

Unity

STATUS

Fully playable, functionally complete

DEVELOPER

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This document is a publisher pitch for a finished game seeking a publishing partner for launch. All publishing rights are unencumbered and available.

1 Fact sheet

TITLE	Cargo Industry
GENRE	Simulation • Strategy • Management
SUB-GENRE	Transportation and industrial economy
MODE	Single-player
PLATFORM	Windows 10/11 (64-bit), DirectX 11/12, Steam
ENGINE	Unity
TEAM	Solo developer
ART	Licensed Synty Studios / Unity Asset Store 3D assets, custom interface
BUILD STATUS	Fully playable, functionally complete
STORE STATUS	Steam page live, listed as <i>Coming soon</i> (App ID 5155330)
LANGUAGES	English (interface)
RELEASE	[TO BE ADDED]
PRICE POINT	[TO BE ADDED]
SEEKING	Publishing partner for launch

Rights status Cargo Industry is self-published under the developer's own trading name. **No third-party publisher is attached to the project**, and no publishing, distribution or revenue-share commitments exist with any party. All rights are unencumbered and available for negotiation.

The name "Indicatrix Studio" appears in Steam's publisher field because Steam requires that field to be filled even for self-published titles. It is the developer's own label, not an external company.

— Design lineage

The game is conceptually inspired by two classic titles. **Transport Tycoon** (1994, MicroProse) informs the transport and infrastructure gameplay structure. **Industry Giant** (1997, JoWood) informs the industrial and production concept.

2 Game overview

Cargo Industry is a single-player transportation and industrial management strategy game. The player builds a railway and road network, decides where industry is located, staffs it, and earns revenue by moving raw materials and finished goods across a procedurally generated world.

- **What the player does.** Constructs rails and roads, bridges and tunnels, stations and depots; builds and staffs factories; configures trains and road vehicles; defines routes; earns revenue from delivered cargo and reinvests it into expansion.
- **The world.** Every game generates a new 256×256 tile map with cities of varying size, terrain, water bodies, forests and world objects.
- **The hook.** Factories are not pre-placed by the game. The player chooses *where* each facility is built and *which type* it is, within the constraints of the generated terrain.
- **The scope.** Cargo only. There is no passenger transport; the entire economy is materials, production and goods.
- **The experience.** Long-form, low-pressure systems building. The satisfaction comes from a network that works, not from time pressure or combat.



A player-built network between Bridgeford and Riverholt: a rail line carries coal from the mine at Bridgeford Central through a tunnel to the power station at Riverholt Central, while a separate road links Bridgeford North with the power station at Riverholt North. Track, road, tunnel, depots and stations are all placed by the player.

3 The core experience

The player operates a growing transport and industry company in a world that has just been drawn for the first time.

— Emotional core

The planner's satisfaction of seeing a supply chain close and start paying for itself, combined with ownership of the map: the industrial geography is authored by the player rather than inherited. Growth stays legible, with a monthly calendar and a running credit balance permanently visible in the HUD.

— Pace

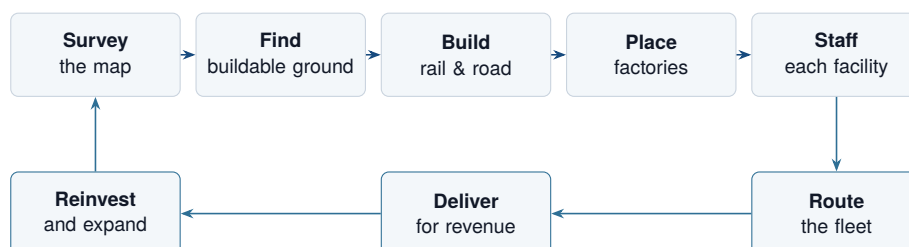
Deliberate and continuous rather than mission-driven. Sessions run as an ongoing operation across in-game months and years, not as a sequence of discrete levels. There is no combat, no fail state and no timer; the pressure is economic and self-imposed.

— The activity mix

Surveying the map through the Terrain, Industry, Rail and Road overlays; scouting buildable ground, since terrain, trees, rocks, water and existing cities all block construction; laying track and road, bridging water and tunnelling through high ground, and terraforming; placing and staffing industry; configuring vehicles and routes; then reading the results and optimising.

Why it holds attention. Every new map invalidates the previous optimal layout, and every factory placement is a bet on the network the player is going to build around it.

4 Core gameplay loop



— Where the decisions are

Siting. Factory placement is bounded by the physical map: terrain elevation, trees, rocks, water surfaces and existing cities all block construction. Finding viable ground is a genuine search rather than a cost check.

Mode. Rail or road, each with its own network, stations, depots and vehicle catalogue.

Crossing. Water and high ground are obstacles to route around or to cross. A lake can be spanned by one of three bridge types, a hill can be tunnelled, a line can pass over an existing bridge on a higher deck level, and rail and road can meet at a shared level crossing.

Labour. Every operating factory needs an assigned worker at a chosen salary tier.

— The economy

Cargo delivery revenue is the sole income source, and it funds all expansion: track, roads, depots, vehicles, factories and wages. Factories interconnect automatically based on the resources they receive and produce, so the player designs the supply chain and the network that serves it in the same pass. Statistical and analytical tables track network and economic performance.

5 Gameplay systems

— Infrastructure construction

Tile-based building on an isometric grid. The rail and road construction panels each expose the same terrain tool set (level up, level down, demolish, bridge and tunnel), a full piece set, four depot orientations and two station types. Routes are not restricted to right angles: diagonal track is supported, with a range of junctions and switches for flexible connections. Roads form a parallel, separately built network with their own stations and vehicles.

— Bridges and tunnels

Both networks can cross water and high ground. Placing track or road across a gap opens a choice of three bridge types, each modelled in rail and road variants and in both isometric orientations: a **stone arch viaduct**, a **steel truss bridge** and a **suspension bridge**. Tunnels carry rail or road through elevated terrain instead of over it.

Bridges are not limited to a single level. A new bridge can be built above an existing one on a higher deck, so crossings can be stacked where space is tight instead of being spread out across the map.



RAIL • VIADUCT



RAIL • TRUSS



RAIL • SUSPENSION



RAIL TUNNEL



ROAD • VIADUCT



ROAD • TRUSS



ROAD • SUSPENSION



ROAD TUNNEL

Stone arch viaduct, steel truss and suspension bridges in rail and road variants, with the rail and road tunnel portals.

— Mixed rail and road crossings

Rail and road are separate networks, but they are not forced to avoid each other. Where a road meets a railway it can cross at grade through a mixed rail–road crossing, which lets the two modes share the same corridor and the same towns without a bridge at every intersection.

— Industry — player placed

Sixteen buildable facility types, split into seven **producers** (coal, gold, silver and iron ore mines, oil wells, farm, forest) and nine **processors** (oil refinery, electronics factory, furniture factory, power station, sawmill, slaughterhouse, grain factory, smelter, glass factory). Each built facility can be inspected for its required and produced resources.

— Resource and production chain

Sixteen material and product types. Raw materials: coal, wood, iron ore, gold ore, silver ore, livestock, grain and oil. Processed goods: boards, plastic, meat, flour, metals, glass, furniture and electronics products. Every raw material has a processing destination, and revenue is earned when cargo is unloaded at a facility that accepts it.

- **Energy.** Coal from coal mines is delivered to power stations.
- **Metals.** Iron, gold and silver ore all feed the smelter, which produces metals; the glass factory turns metals into glass.
- **Timber and oil.** Forests supply wood to sawmills for boards; oil wells supply the refinery, which produces plastic.
- **Food.** Farms produce both livestock, processed into meat at the slaughterhouse, and grain, milled into flour at the grain factory.
- **Manufacturing.** The electronics factory combines plastic, glass and metals; the furniture factory combines the same three with boards. These multi-input plants are where separate supply lines have to converge.

— Staff management

Every factory requires an assigned worker or it does not operate. Sixteen professions match the facility set, each with an illustrated portrait, a role description and a choice of three salary tiers. Labour is therefore a recurring cost centre rather than a one-off unlock.

— Vehicles and depots

Depot-based fleet management with one active vehicle per depot, which makes depot placement a network-planning decision. Rail offers three locomotive types and sixteen wagon types; road offers sixteen cargo vehicle types, matched to cargo categories. Per-vehicle commands cover start, stop, remove, recall to depot, route definition and route deletion.

— Network resilience

If a rail line or road is destroyed while a vehicle is in transit, the vehicle stops rather than failing. Once the connection is rebuilt it reroutes automatically and resumes its journey. Reorganising a mature network mid-operation is a supported play pattern rather than a punishment.



Depot management at Windford: an Iron Dragon locomotive with ten wood wagons crossing the lake on a suspension bridge between the forest at Windford North and Windford Central, with per-train start, stop, remove, recall and route commands.

6 Unique selling points

— 1. Player-authored industry, not pre-placed industry

What it is. The player chooses both the location and the type of every factory, within terrain constraints. Nothing is seeded automatically.

Why it matters. Industrial geography becomes a strategic decision instead of a constraint to react to. Because terrain, water, trees, rocks and cities block placement, a good site is something the player earns by reading the map.

Why it differentiates. Most transport tycoons ask the player to serve an existing industrial map. Cargo Industry asks the player to design the supply chain and the network that serves it in the same pass.

— 2. Staffing as an operating constraint

What it is. Each factory needs an assigned worker from a sixteen-profession roster, with selectable salary tiers.

Why it matters. Expansion carries an ongoing labour cost and an assignment decision, so growth is not purely a construction-cost problem.

Why it differentiates. It layers a workforce and operating-cost system onto a genre that usually models only capital expenditure and vehicle running costs.

— 3. Two fully separate transport modes on one economy

What it is. Rail (three locomotives, sixteen wagon types) and road (sixteen cargo vehicle types), each with its own network, stations and depots.

Why it matters. Short local hauls and long bulk corridors demand different answers.

Why it differentiates. Both modes are first-class build systems with dedicated Rail View and Road View map overlays, rather than road being a token second option.

— 4. Multi-level bridges and mixed crossings

What it is. Three bridge types and tunnels for both rail and road, bridges that can be stacked above one another on higher deck levels, and mixed rail–road crossings where the two networks meet at grade.

Why it matters. Terrain stops being a wall. Lakes, hills and crowded junctions become engineering choices, and two transport modes can share tight corridors instead of competing for the same tiles.

Why it differentiates. In classic Transport Tycoon every bridge sits on a single level and cannot pass over another bridge. Stacked bridges let the player build compact, layered interchanges that the genre's reference title does not allow.

— 5. A network the player can rebuild while it runs

What it is. Diagonal track and a full junction and switch set allow flexible layouts, and automatic rerouting means a vehicle stranded by a demolished line resumes once the connection is restored.

Why it matters. Reorganising a mature network is the most common late-game activity in this genre, and usually the most punishing.

Why it differentiates. It removes the standard penalty for iterating on your own layout, which suits a game built around continuous optimisation.

— 6. A new world every run

What it is. Procedurally generated 256×256 tile maps with varied city sizes, terrain elevation, water, forests and world objects.

Why it matters. Replayability comes from the map itself rather than from authored scenarios.

Why it differentiates. Combined with player-placed, terrain-constrained industry, no two campaigns share the same optimal layout.

7 World and setting

- **Scale.** 256×256 tiles per generated world — a continent-scale landmass with dozens of lakes and settlements.
- **Settlements.** Cities of clearly different tiers, from small clusters of low-rise houses to dense downtown blocks with high-rise towers.
- **Naming.** English compound place names with cardinal station suffixes (Central, North, South, East), giving the world a readable North-Atlantic railway flavour.
- **Terrain.** Elevation is modelled in five bands from sea level to 100 m and above, exposed in the terrain overlay. Lakes and rivers block factory placement and shape routing: a line either goes around them or crosses by bridge, and high ground can be tunnelled.
- **World objects.** Rocks, tree groupings, ponds and park tiles are not decoration only: they physically block factory placement.
- **Era.** The calendar runs from 1950 onward. Steam locomotives, period road vehicles and locomotive names such as *Iron Dragon* and *Thunderbolt* place the game in a mid-twentieth-century industrial setting. Currency is displayed as CR.

— Narrative scope

Cargo Industry is systems-driven, with no narrative campaign, protagonist or dialogue. The only characters are the sixteen illustrated staff archetypes in the hiring screen, which give the otherwise abstract economy a human layer.



A freshly generated world at Silverbrook in February 1950: a high-rise city, lakes, woodland and world objects, before any track, road or factory is placed: the physical constraints on where industry can be built.

8 Art direction and visual identity

— Production approach

Cargo Industry combines a **licensed low-poly 3D art base** (Synty Studios / Unity Asset Store) with a **custom-built pixel-art interface layer**. The production strategy is deliberate: as a solo production, engineering effort goes into systems depth while a proven, internally coherent commercial art library carries the world layer.

— The visual signature is the interface

A retro, pixel-styled interface sits over the 3D world: parchment-coloured panels in brown pixel frames with green title bars, bitmap typography, bevelled green pixel buttons, hand-painted pixel icons in the bottom toolbar, and a status bar along the top edge that keeps trains, vehicles, stations, factories, cargo load, monthly and yearly profit and revenue permanently in view. This is consistent across every screen and is the most distinctive and ownable element of the game's presentation.

— Camera, colour and atmosphere

A fixed-angle isometric view over a diamond-tile grid, with zoom control. The build cursor is a white tile outline, so the grid is explicit during construction and invisible during play. The palette runs from saturated mid-green terrain and blue water through grey, teal, red and cream facades to black-and-rust rolling stock; infrastructure always reads darker than terrain, so the network is the first thing the eye follows. Crossings carry the period setting: grey stone viaducts, dark steel trusses and red suspension spans, with stone-faced tunnel portals set into grassed hillsides. The tone is bright, daylit and calm — orderly and constructive rather than gritty, which matches the pace of play.

— Information design

Persistent world-space labels name every station and city. The map screen carries full colour legends for the Industry View, with a key per facility type, and the Terrain View, covering elevation bands, water, towns, railways, rail stations, roads and road stations. Readability is treated as a first-class art concern.



The pixel-art interface layer over the low-poly world: rail construction and depot panels at Foxhaven.

The strategic map with full colour legends.



The staff management screen introduces a third visual register: painted character portraits alongside the low-poly geometry and the pixel interface.

9 Target audience

— Primary

Players of transport, logistics and industrial management simulations who want long single-player building sessions and explicit control over supply chains. Specifically, the audience that

grew up with — or still plays — Transport Tycoon and Industry Giant and their descendants.

— Secondary

City-builder and tycoon players who enjoy optimisation and network design more than combat or narrative; automation and resource-management players drawn to supply-chain construction; and players who value procedural replayability and sandbox freedom over authored scenarios.

— Positioning

Single-player economic simulation and management strategy on PC. Cargo Industry competes on depth of the player-authored supply chain rather than on graphical spectacle or scale of simulation. The interface is currently English only, and localisation is one of the areas where publisher support is sought.

Audience signal from the live store page. The tags already attached to the Steam page form a coherent cluster around exactly this audience, with **Trains**, **Automation** and **Economy** as the strongest discovery hooks, alongside Simulation, Strategy, Management, Resource Management, Building, City Builder, Isometric, Grid-Based Movement, 1990's and Singleplayer.

Wishlist and follower figures: [TO BE ADDED]

10 Market positioning

Cargo Industry sits between its two stated inspirations. It takes the network-and-vehicle layer of a transport tycoon and hands the player the industrial map that those games normally generate automatically, then adds a staffing constraint, terrain-limited siting and multi-level bridge construction on top. It is cargo-only and single-player by design — a focused product rather than a broad simulation.

— Comparable titles

[TO BE ADDED — COMPARABLE GAMES]

Sales, review and wishlist benchmarks for directly comparable current-market titles are to be compiled together with the publishing partner, whose market data will be more reliable than public estimates.

— Suggested benchmarks (not verified comparables)

The following titles occupy adjacent shelf space and are offered as research starting points rather than as claims about audience overlap or commercial performance: OpenTTD, Transport Fever 2, Railway Empire, Mashinky, Rise of Industry and Voxel Tycoon. Any figures used in negotiation should be sourced independently before they are relied upon.

11 Development status

Current state: fully playable and functionally complete. The build is considered complete enough for release. A playable build is available to interested partners on request. No completion percentage is claimed.

— Implemented and verified in the current build

- Procedural world generation at 256×256 tiles, with cities of varying size, terrain elevation, water, vegetation and world objects
- Rail construction: terraforming, full rail piece set including diagonals, junctions and switches, four depot orientations and two station types
- Road construction with its own stations and vehicles
- Bridges in three types (stone viaduct, steel truss, suspension) for rail and road, buildable above one another on multiple deck levels
- Rail and road tunnels
- Mixed rail–road crossings
- Sixteen buildable facility types with terrain-constrained placement and automatic resource-based interconnection
- Sixteen-resource production and processing chain, with every raw material, including gold and silver ore, feeding a processor
- Staff management: sixteen professions, hiring, assignment and three salary tiers
- Depot-based fleet management: three locomotives, sixteen wagon types, sixteen road cargo vehicles
- Route definition and per-vehicle control
- Automatic path rerouting after infrastructure damage and rebuild
- Cargo delivery revenue economy with monthly calendar and persistent balance
- Strategic map with Terrain, Industry, Rail and Road overlays and full legends
- Statistical and analytical tables

— Open design question

Objectives and win conditions are not yet finalised. The game is currently built around open-ended network construction and optimisation. A more defined objective structure may be introduced or refined during further development, and this is an area where publisher input on the target market's expectations would be valuable.

— Development disclosure

Generative AI tools were used as **programming assistance** during development — code generation, code modification, debugging and exploring solutions — and AI-assisted code is present in the released codebase. This is disclosed on the Steam store page in line with Valve's requirements. All world art consists of licensed commercial assets; all design, systems, procedural generation and interface work are the developer's own. The section that follows sets out the full development history.

12 Development history

JUL 2024	Project begins as a part-time hobby project, developed irregularly rather than daily
	Initial architecture created
17 MAR 2025	
TO 17 JAN 2026	Roughly 40 % of development completed without any AI assistance , covering the core architecture, the tile system and terrain rendering
FROM JAN 2026	AI adopted as a programming assistant (ChatGPT, Claude Sonnet / Opus)
	Most intensive development period
APR--JUN 2026	
AUG 2026	Game completed

— Codebase

Eighty-six source files in total, of which roughly twenty are main source files.

— How AI was used

The foundational systems — architecture, tile system and terrain rendering, amounting to about 40 % of the work — were written without AI over the first eighteen months of the project. From January 2026, ChatGPT and Claude (Sonnet and Opus) were used as programming assistants for code generation, modification and debugging, across roughly fifty prompts in total. AI-assisted code is present in the codebase and is disclosed on the Steam store page in line with Valve's requirements. All design, systems and interface decisions are the developer's own.

13 Team and production approach

— Martin Timothy Timko — solo developer, Indicatrix Studio

Cargo Industry is designed, programmed and produced by a single developer in Unity. Indicatrix Studio is the developer's own trading name, used for self-publishing; no third-party publisher is attached to the project and all publishing rights are unencumbered and available. World art is licensed from Synty Studios and the Unity Asset Store, while the interface, systems, procedural generation and all game logic are the developer's own work.

Location: [TO BE ADDED]

— What a solo production means for a partner

- **A complete, shippable product already exists.** No development risk is carried from zero, and no milestone funding is required to reach a playable state.
- **Decision-making is direct.** Balancing changes, feature requests and store-facing iterations go straight to the person who wrote the code, with no coordination overhead.
- **Ongoing capacity is retained.** The developer continues to develop and improve the game before and after launch.
- **The gaps are exactly the publisher's strengths.** Marketing, QA, localisation, PR, store strategy and launch management are the areas outside a solo developer's reach, and they are precisely what is being asked for.

14 Business model

Cargo Industry is positioned as a premium single-player PC title on Steam. The final release model, price point and post-launch plan are deliberately open, to be defined together with a publishing partner using their pricing and market expertise.

- Release model, premium 1.0 versus Early Access: [TO BE ADDED]
- Target price point: [TO BE ADDED]
- Additional storefronts beyond Steam: [TO BE ADDED]
- Post-launch content plan: [TO BE ADDED]

The developer is open to discussing publishing, revenue-share, funding and partnership structures according to the publisher's level of involvement.

15 Roadmap and next steps

— Now

Feature-complete build. Steam page live as *Coming soon*. Internal balancing and refinement.

— Next, with a publishing partner

1. **Final production and QA** — external testing, bug identification, balancing feedback
2. **Design consultation** — resolving the objectives and win-condition question against target-market expectations
3. **Store page optimisation** — capsule art, screenshots, trailer strategy, wishlist campaign
4. **Localisation** — game and store materials beyond English
5. **Marketing and PR ramp** — positioning, campaign, media and content-creator outreach
6. **Launch** — coordinated release and post-launch support window

Target release window: [TO BE ADDED] Desired time from signing to launch: [TO BE ADDED]

The developer is open to additional development or content work if a publisher identifies areas that would significantly improve market potential.

16 The ask

Cargo Industry is looking for a publishing partner to bring a finished game to market. The product exists, is playable, and has a live Steam page. The ask is not development funding from zero — it is commercial partnership on final preparation, launch, and everything after it.

Publishing and distribution	Releasing the game on relevant PC platforms and managing the publishing process
Marketing and promotion	Developing and executing a marketing strategy: positioning, campaigns, trailers, promotional materials, social media, PR and visibility within the target audience
Steam and store presence	Store-page optimisation, presentation, screenshot and trailer strategy, visibility and wishlists
QA and final production	Testing, bug identification, balancing feedback and assistance preparing the game for release
Localisation	Translating the game and store materials for international markets
PR and media outreach	Connecting the game with gaming media, influencers, content creators and industry channels
Business and market expertise	Advice on pricing, release strategy, target markets and commercial positioning
Launch management	Support before, during and after release

— Rights status

Self-published under the developer's own label. No publishing, distribution or revenue-share commitments exist with any third party. All rights are available for negotiation.

— Partnership structure

The preferred arrangement is a long-term, mutually beneficial publishing partnership in which the publisher contributes industry expertise, marketing capability, distribution network and commercial experience, while the developer retains the ability to continue developing and improving the game. Publishing, revenue-share, funding and partnership terms are open to discussion based on the publisher's level of involvement and the needs of the project.

Cargo Industry is a finished transport and industry strategy game where the player draws the rails, bridges the water, chooses where industry can stand, hires the people who run it, and earns every credit by moving the goods. **A new world every time.**

It is built. It needs a partner to put it in front of the people who have been waiting for it.

STEAM STORE PAGE

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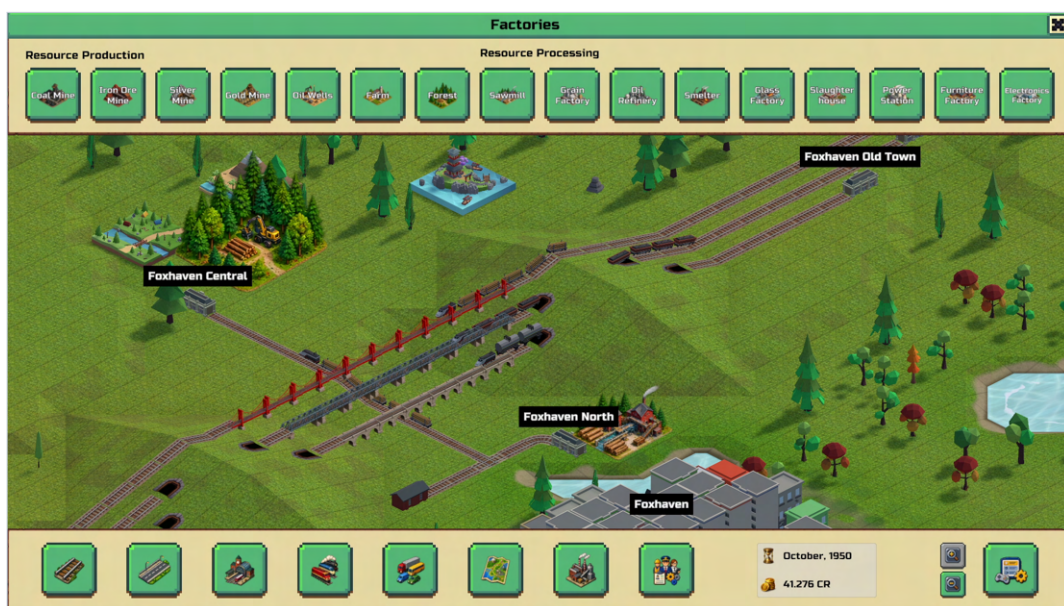
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Appendix • Screenshot gallery

All screenshots are captured from the current playable build at 1920×1080 . Higher-resolution material is available on request.



01 — Windford: an Iron Dragon locomotive with ten wood wagons crossing the lake on a suspension bridge between the forest at Windford North and Windford Central, with the Rail Depot panel open.



02 — The Factories menu with seven resource producers and nine processors, over Foxhaven: three bridge types side by side on one multi-line network.



03 — Rail construction at Foxhaven: the terrain, rail, depot and station tools open alongside the Rail Depot panel, with a farm at Foxhaven South, a bridge, a tunnel and a cluster of depots on the line.



04 — Staff Management: sixteen professions, illustrated portraits, role descriptions and the three salary tiers.



05 — The strategic map with Terrain, Industry, Rail and Road views and full colour legends, over the city of Bridgeford and its coal mine.



06 — Bridgeford and Riverholt: coal by rail from the mine at Bridgeford Central through a tunnel to the power station at Riverholt Central, and a separate road from Bridgeford North to the power station at Riverholt North.



07 — Fairbrook: a road corridor carrying wood from the forest at Fairbrook Central to the sawmill at Fairbrook North, with a road depot on the route, operating independently of rail.



08 — Silverbrook in February 1950: a freshly generated world with a high-rise city, lakes, woodland and landmark tiles, before any construction and with the full 50,000 CR starting capital.



09 — Key art: the Cargo Industry logo over an in-game view of Bridgeford and Riverholt.